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Real News in Real Time



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‘He continues!’

....Incumbent Hakainde Hichilema (UPND) wins 2026 general election

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By Ruth Kambita

Incumbent President Hakainde Hichilema of the United Party for National Development (UPND) has won the 2026 general election with 2,965,326 votes, beating his nearest rival, Brian Mundubile of the Tonse Alliance, who scored 1,856,217. Returning Officer Mwangala Zaloumis declared Mr Hichilema the winner at around 02:45 today to a jubilant UPND crowd at Lusaka’s Mulungushi International Conference Centre.

The University of Zambia (UNZA) Great East Road campus erupted in celebration even before the official declaration as students welcomed the assurance of an increased accommodation allowance.

Mr Hichilema led the count from the start of the announcements and steadily widened the gap with Mr Mundubile of the National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP).

Speaking to journalists after the declaration UPND National Chairperson Collins Maoma commended Zambians for protecting democracy through peaceful voting, thanking campaigners, alliance partners and supporters.

He praised President Hakainde Hichilema’s calming leadership, noting no election skirmishes. “No victor, no vanquished — democracy won,” he said, urging churches, unions and media to promote peace and unity as the country pursues development.

One of the Alliance Partners Miles Sampa said he advocated for President Elect Hakainde Hichilema on merit-based support in politics, emphasizing the importance of performance over tribal affiliations.

Bishop Martin Silwimba,

president of the Bishops’ Council of Zambia, congratulated the President-elect of Zambia, emphasizing the importance of unity and peace. He called for supporters to embrace their opponents and avoid conflict, highlighting that Zambia as a nation has triumphed.

Bishop Silwimba also warned the public to celebrate

safely to prevent accidents and further called for the president-elect to unite the nation, regardless of political differences, and thanks the people for their support.

After the penultimate batch of results was announced — which showed Mr Hichilema leading with 2,430,702 votes to Mr Mundubile’s 1,461,457

at Mulungushi International Conference Centre, UPND National Management Committee member Mulambo Haimbe thanked Zambians for what he described as “a historic” and “ecstatic” result.

He said the margin reflected public confidence in President Hichilema and highlighted a turnout of approximately 56

percent.

Mr Haimbe urged unity after the contest, saying elections should not divide the nation. “An election is just a process,” he said, appealing to Zambians to remain peaceful and to embrace one another regardless of the result. “Let us unite. Let us continue to be peaceful even after this election result has

been announced.”

Representatives from civil society organisations echoed calls for restraint and urged the use of legal avenues for grievances. They urged losing parties to avoid protests and instead seek redress in court, saying conflict management is crucial and that the judiciary should adjudicate any disputes.



UPND Members and alliance partners in jubilation as Hakainde Hichilema is declared President elect for the 2026 Presidential elections. Picture by Alex Maboshe

Simon in Lusaka’s lane

By Alex Maboshe

Prominent vlogger and property developer Simon Mwewa Chitambala, widely known as Simon Mwewa Lane, has been elected Mayor of Lusaka for 2026 on the United Party for National Development (UPND) ticket.

Mr Chitambala defeated NRPUP candidate Gabriel Kikombwe and independent contender Simon Mwila to claim victory.

His campaign gained momentum through a consistent focus on environmental cleanliness and orderly public spaces.

By encouraging residents to maintain a tidy city, he steadily built public recognition and trust across Lusaka.

Since the official announcement of his win, several public figures have congratulated Chitambala, expressing confidence that he is well suited to lead the capital.

Meanwhile, Lusaka business man Alexander Sakala has also scooped the Matero Constituency member of Parliament seat beating Resolute Party candidate Patrick Salubusa.

Also UPND’s Thomas Sipalo has been elected Munalu Constituency Member of Parliament after getting 27,242 votes.



Real News in Real Time

We don't support violence - Mundubile

By Alex Maboshe

National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP) leader Brian Mundubile has denied government claims that some of his party's senior members were arrested alongside a foreign militia linked to illegal military training camps

In a statement posted on his

official Facebook page today, Mr Mundubile described the allegations as baseless and called for their immediate retraction.

"NRPUP has no militia. We do not support violence, nor do we support any attempt to overthrow the constitutional order of our country," he said.

He said the accusations were serious and carried grave consequences for those

named and for Zambia as a whole, and he specifically urged Secretary to the Cabinet Patrick Kangwa to withdraw the claims without delay.

Mr Mundubile stressed that anyone accused of breaking the law should be afforded due process and that evidence should be tested in court.

"Political allegations must never be allowed to become a substitute for evidence," he said.

The NRPUP leader reaffirmed his party's commitment to peace and national unity.

"We stand for peace. We stand for Zambia.

We will never support violence, intimidation, destruction of property or persecution of any Zambian because of how they voted," he said, adding that the country is greater than any political party, candidate or election.

While insisting on the importance of peace, Mr Mundubile said this should not mean silence. He raised concerns about the 2026 election, saying such issues must be addressed openly, transparently and within the law.

Complaints should be heard, discrepancies investigated, errors corrected and any unlawful conduct dealt with through proper legal channels, he said.

He added that NRPUP would pursue every legitimate and constitutional avenue to seek justice.

Learner council establishment backed

By Linda Nyondo

The Zambia National Education Coalition (ZANEC) has welcomed the Ministry of Education's directive for all schools to set up learner councils, saying the move will help deter abuse and improve pupil safety.

The instruction, issued after a recent bullying incident at a named school involving a pupil previously regarded as a role model, requires every school to establish a student-led council to report and address misconduct.

Henry Kabwe, ZANEC's board chairperson, said learner councils would provide

pupils with a channel to report bullying, abuse, teacher absenteeism and other concerns before they escalate.

"This is a bold step towards putting learners at the centre of school safety, governance and access to quality education," he said.

Mr Kabwe added that the directive was long overdue, noting that schools had frequently failed to implement provisions of the Education Act of 2011, which envisages such councils.

ZANEC has urged the ministry to publish clear guidelines on the formation, protection and governance of learner councils to ensure they remain

genuinely learner-led. The coalition also called for teacher training on safeguarding and on facilitating meaningful child participation.

The organisation said the councils must be inclusive of boys, girls and learners with disabilities, and should be linked to school guidance and counselling services.

"Bullying and other forms of abuse, such as sexual harassment, thrive in silence. Learner councils will help to break that silence," Mr Kabwe said.

ZANEC has committed to supporting the government to ensure the new councils are functional and that they protect all pupils.

Airborne mine survey nears completion

By Ruth Kambita

Mines' Permanent Secretary Hapenga Kabeta says Zambia's countrywide airborne geophysical survey is 88.9 per cent complete, with only a handful of districts remaining.

The exercise, launched in 2024, is designed to generate modern, high-resolution data on the country's mineral potential to guide exploration and resource management.

Dr. Kabeta described the survey as a significant investment in the mining

sector, noting that the last similar nationwide exercise was carried out in 1972 using outdated technology.

He said the current survey, conducted with new technologies, can detect a wider range of minerals across all parts of the country, improving the accuracy of resource estimates and exploration targeting.

Only a few districts remain to be covered, including Kaputa and Mbala in Northern Province, as well as Kawambwa and Milenge, according to the Permanent Secretary.

Lusangazi man survives gunshot

By Ruth Kambita

A 30-year-old man of Lusangazi District has been hospitalised after he was allegedly shot by an unknown assailant at his home.

Philimon Ngulube of Nyampande Village was seated outside his house with his friend, Dominic Daka, waiting for supper when he heard a gunshot from behind.

He later realised he

had been shot on the left shoulder and sustained a bleeding wound.

Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba said the two did not see the person who fired the shot.

Mr Mweemba said the victim reported the matter to police and was issued with a medical report form.

He said Mr Ngulube is admitted to Petauke District Hospital, where he is receiving treatment.

Man kills self over marital dispute

By Ruth Kambita

A 22-year-old man of Nyimba District has taken his own life on grounds that he was always considered to be on the wrong side whenever he had a marital dispute with his wife.

It is alleged that Gift Mwanza, now the deceased, told his mother, Betty Lungu, on August 15, 2026, at around 09:00 hours that he had decided to take his own life because he was always blamed whenever he had disagreements with his wife.

Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba said Mr Mwanza who had been married to 20-year-old Titamenji Banda for two years, had reportedly been experiencing marital disputes, which

allegedly resulted in Ms Banda leaving the matrimonial home to stay with her biological parents.

Mr Mweemba said after Mr Mwanza informed his mother that he had swallowed the poison, she alerted neighbours, who gave him milk and charcoal in an attempt to neutralise the substance.

Mr Mweemba said Mr Mwanza was later rushed to Nyimba District Hospital before being referred to a general hospital, where he died.

He said police visited Nyimba District Hospital and found the deceased lying lifelessly, with no visible physical injuries.

Mr Mweemba said the body was deposited in the mortuary by relatives to facilitate burial arrangements, adding that no foul play was suspected.

Acceptance cardinal - SACCORD

By Linda Nyondo

The Southern Africa Centre for the Constructive Resolution of Disputes (SACCORD) has urged Zambians to accept the outcome of the August 13, 2026, general election and manage any aftermath peacefully.

Arthur Muyunda, a SACCORD representative, warned those aggrieved not to take to the streets.

"Our appeal is to the UPND presidential candidate Hakainde Hichilema and the NRPUP presidential candidate Brian Mundubile to ask their supporters not to go to the streets," he said.

Mr Muyunda said the two leaders have the power to curtail disturbances that might arise from electoral disputes. He also called on law enforcement agencies to remain vigilant and to carry out their duties within the law to prevent any lawlessness.

"We are calling for calm to all Zambians. This is not the first time we are having elections and it will not be the

last time," Mr Muyunda added, acknowledging that it is difficult for parties with large followings to accept defeat.

He urged losing candidates to use their influence to unite the nation, and advised winners to embrace those they defeated.

"Embrace the losers, look at their good ideas and work with them. Your ultimate goal is to serve Zambians and not yourself," he said, suggesting a government of national unity would be ideal.

Mr Muyunda also appealed to young people not to allow themselves to be used to perpetrate violence and encouraged anyone who is emotionally or mentally affected by the result to seek psychosocial counselling.

SACCORD thanked the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) for its efforts to deliver a transparent and credible election, and Mr Muyunda urged Zambians to congratulate themselves for holding peaceful elections.

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Selected pictures taken shortly after the second batch of the announcement of the results for the Presidential candidates for the 2026 General Elections at Mulungushi International Conference Center. Pictures by Ruth Kambita.

HH pledges more development

By Ruth Kambita

President-elect Hakainde Hichilema has pledged to serve all Zambians and prioritise national unity, peace and development following his election victory. Mr Hichilema said the election had demonstrated Zambia's commitment to democracy, the rule of law and

the peaceful resolution of political differences through the ballot box. "We are truly humbled by the trust you have placed in our hands to hold our nation's highest office and to be your servant once more," he said. He said his campaign had taken him and his team to all 116 districts, including cities,

compounds, villages and farms, where they witnessed first-hand the challenges facing citizens. Mr Hichilema promised to work with Zambians to address the challenges and deliver development across the country. He also extended an olive branch to citizens who supported other political parties,

assuring them that his administration would work for every Zambian. "To those citizens who preferred the ideas presented by our opponents, we hear you, and we will continue to work for you to ensure that every Zambian benefits from the development we are delivering," he said. Mr Hichilema further

pledged to build a better future for children and future generations, saying the memories of children encountered during the campaign would remain with him. He called on Zambians to focus on development and progress, anchored on unity, cooperation and a shared national purpose.

"Now we must work harder than ever before to deliver meaningful development for every single Zambian, in every corner of our country," he said. Mr Hichilema concluded by urging citizens to unite in building a peaceful and prosperous Zambia under the national motto: "One Zambia, One Nation, One People."

Lwandamina drafts 4 U-17 stars to his 2027 AFCON prep squad

By Benedict Tembo

Chipolopolo coach George Lwandamina has named four Under-17 players to his 28-member squad for a local camp and assessment ahead of the 2027 African Cup of Nations (AFCON) qualifiers starting next month.

Zambia, who are in Group 'I' of the qualifying series will face Algeria away on Match Day One before hosting Togo on Match Day Two in September.

The other team in the group is Burundi.

Lwandamina's local assemblage is a mix of young players who featured at the recent Mukuru Four Nations tournament in Botswana and part of the group that played against Argentina in a friendly match in Buenos Aires in March this year.

The Nchanga Rangers tactician has summoned the Zanaco defensive pair of Frederick Mwimanzi and Tinkler Sinkala to the local camp.

Completing the list of defenders are Green Eagles' Headson Paina, Joseph Mulenga of Nchanga Rangers and Jackson Phiri of Konkola Blades.

Also summoned for the assignment are Yoram Chanda of Kabwe Warriors and Mfulira Wanderers' William Kamwanga.

Green Eagles' newly acquired striker Rickson Ng'ambi leads the local bullets alongside team-mate Derrick Bulaya.

Lwandamina has also included the FC MUZA trio of Kelvin Mwanza, Given Kalusa and Chanda Chileshe, while Humphrey Bwembya of Kabwe Warriors, Nchanga Rangers' Elliot Kampukesa and Nkana's Nduna Zulu are also part of the midfield.

FAZ said the assessment camp will not include players from Zambia's Confederation of African Football (CAF) envoys, Champions League contestants Power Dynamos and Red Arrows who will compete in the Confederations Cup.

Also excluded are players from Zesco United who are unavailable due to the club's on-going pre-season tour of Tanzania.

The full squad:-

Goalkeepers: Mangani Banda (Green Eagles), Victor Chabu (Nchanga Rangers), Bradley Mweene (Nkwazi) and Christo Chitamala (Kabwe Warriors).

Defenders: Jonathan Kalimima (Kafue Celtic), Headson Paina (Green Eagles), Joseph Mulenga (Nchanga Rangers), Jackson Phiri (Konkola Blades), Frederick Mwimanzi and Tinkler Sinkala (both Zanaco), Yoram Chanda (Kabwe Warriors) and William Kamwanga (Mfulira Wanderers).

Midfielders: Kelvin Mwanza, Given Kalusa and Chanda Chileshe (all FC MUZA), Humphrey Bwembya (Kabwe Warriors), Elliot Kampukesa (Nchanga Rangers), Nduna Zulu (Nkana), Francis Banda, Dominic Kanda and Ian Sindaye (all Zanaco), Golden Mashata (Green Buffaloes), Patson Kwataine (Mfulira Wanderers) and Kelvin Chipelu (Forest Rangers)

Strikers: Bridger Ngandu (FC MUZA), Abel Nyirongo (Atletico Lusaka), Derrick Bulaya and Rickson Ng'ambi (both Green Eagles).

Accountants 'converge' at Chai to foster wellness and fitness through golf



By Benedict Tembo

Forty eight (48) members of the Zambia Institute of Chartered Accountants (ZICA) on Saturday chose to do something different - abandoned their tools of trade and jargon to take to the greens at Chainama Hills Golf Club.

ZICA says the golf tournament is one of the several initiatives designed to encourage the fitness and wellness of its members away from their busy work schedules.

ZICA president Joseph Matimba said the ZICA Or-

der Of Merit golf tournament, a Strokeplay medal format will be one of the premier events.

"Fitness and wellness is our priority in this Council, we want to see members engage outside work and the AGM (Annual General Meeting)," Matimba said.

He was happy to see a lot of ZICA members turn up to play.

Matimba paid tribute to individual and corporate members for supporting the 18-hole tournament.

He said ZICA intends to increase its engagements with its members, indicating the professional

body's desire to organise an international tour soon to enhance the camaraderie.

ZICA has already settled for the Elephants Hills Golf Club in Zimbabwe, in Victoria Falls Town for the final leg to be held on the sidelines of the 2027 AGM.

Moses Chitoshi, Business Development and Communication Manager, said the next leg of the OoM will be staged at Lusaka Golf Club, with Bonanza in Chongwe and Ndola Golf Club in the Copperbelt hosting the other segments.

"But ultimately, we will

end up at Elephant Hills Golf Club," Chitoshi said.

He hinted at ZICA playing other professionals in the near future.

Chainama Hills Golf Club captain Jonathan Mukosha used the platform to lure ZICA members to join his club which he described as the "academy of golf" which will soon surpass Lusaka Golf Club and Bonanza in terms of offerings.

And Colonel Paul Mukwasa scooped the 'A' Division on 74 net, relegating Simbirai Simwinga who had 77 net into second place with Moses Kazimbaya taking the third

place on 81 net.

Moses Chitoshi was the 'B' Division winner on 70 net, with Rudderford Mandanja losing on countback.

Alick Mutambo finished third at 74 net.

Senior Golfers Association of Zambia president William Mwila dominated the 'C' Division with 74 net, ahead of Kennedy Mwila who had 72 net but winning on countback from Felix Mukonde.

Elisa Manjolo stole the limelight in the Ladies section on 74 net.

Emma Makoni was the runner up on 81 net.